HD Point, report, Landscape, Africa, 2026-10-24

Africa's AI-native startups: where the funding sits and what is being built

Key figures

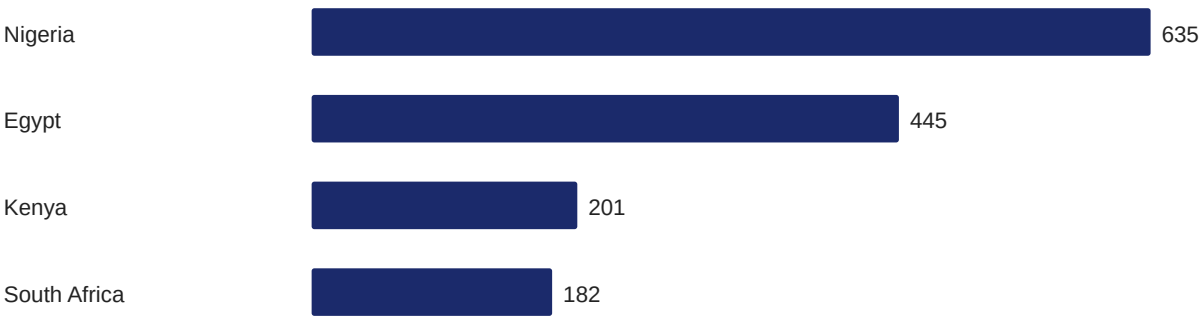
Figure	Value	Basis	Claim
Nigeria	635 million dollars	Verified	c1
Egypt	445 million dollars	Verified	c2
Kenya	201 million dollars	Verified	c3
South Africa	182 million dollars	Verified	c4

What was reported

1. Nigerian startups raised $635 million between January and September 2026, according to data from Africa: The Big Deal. Verified c1
2. Egypt raised $445 million in the same period, according to Africa: The Big Deal. Verified c2
3. Kenyan startups raised $201 million in the first nine months of 2026. Verified c3
4. South Africa raised $182 million in the same period, the least of the four largest markets. Verified c4
5. Nigeria, Egypt, Kenya and South Africa together took 85% of all country-specific startup funding, up from 83% in 2025. Verified c5
6. In the first half of 2026, fintech was the largest funded sector at 41% ($556 million), ahead of logistics and transport at 35% ($472 million) and agriculture and food at 7% ($93 million). Verified c6
7. Tanzania, Côte d’Ivoire and Morocco each attracted more than $25 million in the first half of 2026, as capital spread beyond the four largest markets. Verified c7
8. UNESCO estimates that Africa is home to between 1,500 and 3,000 languages, according to a profile of Botlhale AI. Verified c8
9. Botlhale AI, a South African startup, builds speech recognition and language tools for African languages, aimed at call centres. Verified c9

10. Botlhale says up to 70% of calls in South Africa are in languages other than English. **Company says** c10
11. The company says its models support 11 South African languages and it is expanding to Ghana, Kenya and Nigeria. **Company says** c11
12. Amini, a Kenyan startup, uses satellite imagery and AI to map environmental and agricultural data, including soil, vegetation and carbon levels. **Verified** c12
13. Aerobotics, a South African company, combines AI, drones and data analytics to help farmers monitor crop health. **Verified** c13
14. Africa: The Big Deal is expected to publish a consolidated 2026 funding review before year-end, which will show whether Egypt's 27% share of first-half funding holds. **Verified** c14

Chart



How well sourced is this?

12 of 14 claims are supported by an independent source. 2 come from the company itself and have not been independently checked.

Source	Claims	Basis
https://innovation-village.com/nigeria-reclaims-africas-startup-funding-lead-as-investments-rise-to-635-million/	c1, c5	Verified
https://thewillnews.com/nigeria-leads-africas-10-biggest-startup-funding-markets-with-635m/	c2	Verified
https://technext24.com/news/nigerian-startups-raised-635-million-in-2026/	c3, c4	Verified

https://bitcoinke.io/2026/08/africa-startup-funding-in-h1-2026/	c6	Verified
https://www.techinafrica.com/egypt-tops-africas-h1-2026-startup-funding-but-nigeria-reclaims-the-equity-crown/	c7	Verified
https://www.startup.africa/botlhale-ai-pioneering-inclusive-african-language-tech-for-ai-growth/	c8	Verified
https://iafrica.com/botlhale-ai-brings-speech-recognition-to-african-languages-in-call-centers/	c9, c11	Verified, Company says
https://www.dabafinance.com/en/news/south-africas-botlhale-ai-builds-speech-tech-for-african-languages	c10	Company says
https://thecondia.com/african-startups-ai-problems/	c12, c13	Verified
https://www.capmad.com/post/egypt-emerges-as-africas-top-startup-funding-market-in-h1-2026	c14	Verified

About this report

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